

Angola



A former Portuguese colony ripped apart by constant civil war since independence.

200s BCE Bantu-speakers migrate south into the region.

1482 Portuguese under Diego Cão reach Angola and establish forts along the coast.

1575 Luanda founded by the Portuguese; Portugal later sends troops to collect minerals and slaves, shipping the slaves to its colony in Brazil through Luanda.

1891 The frontiers of Angola are fixed, following the 1884–85 Congress of Berlin. The Portuguese introduce forced labor.

1945 After World War II, Portuguese emigration to Angola increases.

1956 The antitribal Popular Movement for the Liberation of Angola (MPLA) is formed with the aim of ending colonial rule. Led by Agostinho Neto, it later receives support from Soviet bloc countries.

1961 Rebellions in Luanda and northern Angola against colonial rule, followed by severe repression and the launching by the MPLA of the anticolonial armed struggle in the rural areas.

1962 The northern-based National Front for the Liberation of Angola (FNLA) starts insurgency under Holden Roberto; it appeals to tribal allegiances and eventually has support from the US and Zaire.

1966 Formation of National Union for the Total Independence of Angola (UNITA), the third major nationalist movement, led by Jonas Savimbi. By 1990 it controls large parts of the country from its base in Jamba. It receives substantial assistance from the US and South Africa.

1974 Coup in Lisbon leads to the end of Portuguese colonial wars. Independence is scheduled for 1975, and a transitional government is formed by the three nationalist movements. This breaks down and conflict ensues between them.

1975 The MPLA proclaims the People's Republic of Angola with Neto as president. MPLA forces defeat the FNLA in the north and stop South African invasion in support of UNITA some 185 miles (300 km) south of Luanda with the help of Cuban troops.

1979 José Eduardo dos Santos (MPLA) becomes president.

1991 UN-brokered peace but an MPLA election victory provokes UNITA to resume fighting the following year.

1994 Lusaka peace agreement.

1998 Civil war erupts again.

2000 Fighting spreads as UNITA increases guerrilla activity.

2002 UNITA leader Jonas Savimbi killed.

2002 A ceasefire between UNITA rebels and the government brings peace; more than half a million Angolans have died in the fighting since independence.

2008 First parliamentary elections in 16 years are held.

2010 Angola hosts the African Nations soccer tournament. Attack on Togo team bus kills driver and injures several players.

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Zambia



A landlocked southern African country whose fortunes remain tied to the copper industry.

1890s British magnate Cecil Rhodes acquires treaty rights over Barotseland.

1900 British South Africa Company gains mining rights in the region.

1911 Renamed Northern Rhodesia.

1924 Becomes a British protectorate.

1953–63 Part of the Federation of Rhodesia and Nyasaland.

1964 Independent as Zambia with Kenneth Kaunda of the United National Independence Party (UNIP) as president.

1972 UNIP one-party government.

1982–91 Austerity measures and corruption; pressure grows for democracy.

1991 Multi-party democracy; Frederick Chiluba of the Movement for Multi-Party Democracy (MMD) defeats Kaunda.

2001 Levy Mwanawasa of the MMD wins presidential elections.

2007 President Mwanawasa wins a second term, but dies in August 2008 after a stroke. Rupiah Banda replaces him.

2009 Frederick Chiluba is arrested and charged with corruption.

Malawi



A narrow, landlocked country dominated by Lake Malawi, Africa's third-largest lake.

1891 Malawi becomes the British protectorate of Nyasaland after long period of Scottish missionary activity.

1953–63 Colony incorporated into the Federation of Rhodesia and Nyasaland.

1964 Independence as Malawi under Hastings Banda. Two years later Malawi becomes a one-party state.

1992 Antigovernment riots; illegal prodemocracy groups unite.

1993 Referendum for multi-party system.

1994 Bakili Muluzi's opposition United Democratic Front (UDF) wins first democratic elections.

1999 Muluzi reelected president. In 2006 he is arrested on corruption charges.

2002 Severe cholera epidemic.

2004 Bingu wa Mutharika wins presidency.

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Mozambique



A poor country wrecked by civil war that once played a major part in Portugal's slave trade.

1498 Vasco da Gama's arrival at Mozambique Island. Almost half a century later the first Portuguese trading center at Quelimane becomes a center for slave trading to Brazil.

1684 The Mwene Matapa kingdom recognizes Portuguese sovereignty. Later

the Changamire of the Rozvi kingdom conquer the Mwene Matapa and push the Portuguese south of the Zambezi River.

1752 After reestablishing control north of the Zambezi, the Portuguese appoint a colonial governor, having previously run the country as part of Portuguese India.

1780s The slave trade becomes a major factor in the economy. The Portuguese introduce a system of forced labor when slavery is ended in the late 19th century.

1842 Portugal outlaws the slave trade in Mozambique.

1932 Portuguese colonial government takes control of those parts of the country run by private Portuguese companies.

1951 Mozambique becomes an overseas province of Portugal. In the next 20 years Lisbon introduces settlement schemes.

1962 The Front for the Liberation of Mozambique (Frelimo) is formed and starts a war of liberation against Portugal.

1975 Mozambique gains independence; Frelimo leader Samora Machel becomes president.

1976 The Renamo resistance movement is set up inside Mozambique by the white Rhodesian government in order to destabilize its neighbor, which is supporting the ZANU and ZAPU fight against white rule in Rhodesia.

1976–80 Mozambique closes the Rhodesian border to prevent aid reaching Renamo. This leads to numerous reprisals inside the country by Renamo.

1977 Frelimo constitutes itself as a Marxist–Leninist party.

1980 After white minority rule ends in former Rhodesia, South Africa takes over the backing of Renamo.

1982 Zimbabwean troops arrive to guard the vital Mutare–Beira rail link.

1984 Nkomati Accord: South Africa agrees to cease funding Renamo if Mozambique ceases aid to the ANC; however, fighting continues.

1986 Renamo declares war on Zimbabwe; Tanzanian troops arrive to reinforce Frelimo.

1986 President Machel dies in a mysterious plane crash in South Africa; he is succeeded by Joaquim Chissano.

1988 Nkomati Accord is reactivated. Mozambique workers allowed back to work in South African mines.

1989 War and malnutrition claim one million lives.

1989 Frelimo drops Marxism–Leninism and in the new constitution of 1990 supports multi-party elections and the free-market economy.

NDONGO QUEEN (c.1583–1663)

NJINGA MBANDE



Portuguese attempts to colonize the interior of Angola brought them into conflict with the strongly independent Ndongo kingdom. After a period of uneasy peace, fighting broke out in 1617. A peace deal was struck in 1621 when King Ngola Mbande sent his sister Njinga to negotiate with the Portuguese.

On the king's death in 1624, Njinga became queen. She continued to fight the Portuguese, but when they overran her kingdom in 1629, she fled to neighboring Mtamba, captured its ruler, Queen Mwongo, and took control. She ruled her new country successfully and independently until her death in 1663.